
3.2 Assessment information

The unit assessment consists of a single 1 hour 30 minute examination. The examination paper will be divided into four options, one on each application, of which students must select **two**. Each option will correspond with one of the four applications in 3.3. Each option will include short answer questions and a section of extended writing. Extended writing will require a synoptic approach and students will be asked to draw on information from the AS approaches, and other areas including ethical issues, research methods and issues studied such as gender.

There will be 60 marks available for this paper, the unit constitutes 20% of the Advanced GCE.

Students will be expected to be able to answer examination questions focused on practical work conducted within the unit. These questions, should they arise in examination, will assess the content of practical work as well as methodological issues.

3.3a Criminological psychology

Students will be assessed on their ability to:

- 1 **Definition of the application**
 - a Define criminological psychology, showing understanding that it is about the definition and causes of crime and the identification, judgement and treatment of criminals.
 - b Define and use psychological terminology appropriately and accurately including the terms:
 - i crime
 - ii recidivism
 - iii token economy
 - iv anti-social behaviour
 - v stereotyping
 - vi modelling
 - vii eye witness testimony.

2 Methodology/ How Science Works

- a Describe research methods used to assess witness effectiveness including the laboratory experiment and the field experiment.
- b Evaluate, including the relative strengths and weaknesses, the research methods listed in **a** above including:
 - their use in criminological psychology
 - reliability, validity and ethical issues.

Note: In examination, students may be asked about the methods used in the application and asked to describe and evaluate, drawing on other methods both within the application and the five psychological approaches in AS.

3 Content

- a Describe and evaluate two explanations of criminal/antisocial behaviour from different approaches. One explanation must be that of social learning theory (the Learning Approach) including the possible role of the media in modelling antisocial behaviour, and **one** other explanation from either:
 - i one example of how the influence of personality (eg Eysenck) explains criminal behaviour (the Biological Approach)
 - ii labelling and self-fulfilling prophecy (the Social Approach).
- b Describe and evaluate **three** studies into eyewitness testimony including **one** laboratory experiment (eg one of Loftus's laboratory experiments) and **one** field study in detail (eg Yuille & Cutshall (1986) A case study of eyewitness memory of a crime) and **one** other.
- c Describe and evaluate **two** ways of treating offenders including the token economy programme and **one** other.

Suitable examples:

 - punishment
 - anger management
 - social skills training.

Note: In examination, students may be given stimulus material about the application and asked to describe and evaluate, drawing on knowledge of the application and the five psychological approaches in AS.

4 Studies in detail

- a Describe and evaluate Loftus and Palmer's (1974) study of the effect of leading questions on estimate of speed and **one other** study. This **must** be selected from the following:
- Yuille and Cutshall (1986) real-life case study of leading questions and eye witnesses
 - Charlton et al (2000) naturalistic experiment in St Helena
 - Gesch et al (2003) Influence of supplementary vitamins, minerals and essential fatty acids on the anti-social behaviour of young adult prisoners.

5 Evidence in practice: short practical on a key issue

- a Describe **one** key issue in criminological psychology, using the content they have studied within the application,

Suitable examples:

- the issue of the reliability of eyewitness testimony
- the use of offender profiling
- the debate about whether a criminal is 'born or made'.

And either

- b Conduct a content analysis of magazine or newspaper articles (can include TV or web-based material) concerning the key issue. Write up the findings. Draw conclusions about the findings, linked to concepts, theories and/or research (as appropriate) from the topic of relevance.

Or

- c Summarise **two** magazine or newspaper articles (can include TV or web-based material) concerning a topic covered within this application. Write up the summaries. Draw conclusions about the findings, linked to concepts, theories and/or research (as appropriate) from the topic of relevance.

Students can conduct either of these activities but **must** complete one content analysis and one article analysis with summary across their two options.

3.3b Child psychology

Students will be assessed on their ability to:

- 1 **Definition of the application**
 - a Define child psychology, showing understanding that it is about the development of the individual from before birth to adolescence and beyond, in that what we experience as children affects our later development.
 - b Define and use psychological terminology appropriately and accurately including the terms:
 - i attachment
 - ii deprivation
 - iii privation
 - iv evolution
 - v daycare
 - vi separation anxiety.

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- 2 **Methodology/ How Science Works**
 - a Describe the observational research method (including both naturalistic observations and structured observations such as the strange situation) and the case study research method.
 - b Evaluate, including the relative strengths and weaknesses, the research methods in **a** above including:
 - their use in child psychology
 - reliability, validity and ethical issues.
 - c Describe and evaluate cross-cultural and longitudinal ways of studying children in psychology.

Note: In examination, students may be asked about the methods used in the application and asked to describe and evaluate, drawing on other methods both within the application and the five psychological approaches in AS.

3 Content

- a Describe and evaluate Bowlby's theory of attachment (Psychodynamic Approach) and the evolutionary basis of attachment (Biological Approach).
- b Describe and evaluate the work of Ainsworth including the 'strange situation' as a research method and cross-cultural issues regarding child-rearing styles.
- c Describe and evaluate research into deprivation/separation, including Bowlby's maternal deprivation hypothesis and how negative effects can be reduced.
- d Describe and evaluate research into privation, including consideration whether the effects are reversible.
- e Describe the characteristics of and two explanations for **one** of the following: severe learning difficulties, autism, ADHD and explain **two** ways in which such a developmental issue might affect a child's development.
- f Describe and evaluate research into daycare including at least **one** study including the advantages of daycare for the child and **one** study including the disadvantages of daycare for the child.

Note: In examination, students may be given stimulus material about the application and asked to describe and evaluate, drawing on knowledge of the application and the five psychological approaches in AS.

4 Studies in detail

- a Describe and evaluate Curtiss (1977) Genie: a case study of extreme privation and **one other** study. This **must** be selected from the following
 - Bowlby J (1946) Forty-four juvenile thieves — their characters and home-life
 - Belsky J and Rovine M (1988) — Nonmaternal care in the first year of life and the infant parent attachment
 - Rutter and the ERA study team (1998) — Developmental catch-up, and deficit, following adoption after severe global early privation.

5 Evidence in practice: short practical on a key issue

- a Describe **one** key issue in child psychology using the content studied within the application.

Suitable examples:

- the issue of daycare and its effects on child development
- the issue of how the negative effects of deprivation could be alleviated
- the issue as to what extent autism has a biological explanation.

And either

- b Conduct a content analysis of magazine or newspaper articles (can include TV or web-based material) concerning the key issue. Write up the findings. Draw conclusions about the findings, linked to concepts, theories and/or research (as appropriate) from the topic of relevance.

Or

- c Summarise **two** magazine or newspaper articles (can include TV or web-based material) concerning a topic covered within this application. Write up the summaries. Draw conclusions about their findings, linked to concepts, theories and/or research (as appropriate) from the topic of relevance.

Students can conduct either of these activities but **must** complete one content analysis and one article analysis with summary across their two options.

3.3c Health psychology: Substance misuse

Students will be assessed on their ability to:

- 1 **Definition of the application**
 - a Define health psychology, showing understanding that health psychology is about understanding health from study of the biological bases of behaviour (such as the study of drugs and their effects) and the cognitive and social bases for behaviour and that health psychology is about promoting good health.
 - b Define and use psychological terminology appropriately and accurately including the terms:
 - i substance misuse
 - ii synapse
 - iii tolerance
 - iv physical dependence
 - v psychological dependence
 - vi withdrawal.
- 2 **Methodology/ How Science Works**
 - a Describe and evaluate the use of animals in laboratory studies when researching into drugs.
 - b Describe and evaluate two research methods using humans to study the effects of drugs.
 - c Evaluate, including relative strengths and weaknesses, research methods using animals (including both practical and ethical strengths and weaknesses) and humans (including issues of reliability and validity).

Note: In examination, students may be asked about the methods used in the application and asked to describe and evaluate, drawing on other methods both within the application and the five psychological approaches in AS.

3 Content

- a Describe **two** explanations of substance misuse. One explanation must be from the Biological Approach, and one from the Learning Approach. Suitable examples for the explanation from the Learning Approach:
 - i social learning theory and the role of models
 - ii operant conditioning and positive reinforcement of short-term effects
 - iii negative reinforcement of avoidance of withdrawal.
- b Describe and compare relative strengths and weaknesses of explanations from the Biological and Learning Approaches.
- c Describe, with reference to heroin and **one other** drug from alcohol, cocaine, ecstasy, marijuana, smoking/nicotine:
 - i mode of action (eg at the synapse)
 - ii effects
 - iii tolerance (or absence of tolerance)
 - iv physical and/or psychological dependencies
 - v withdrawal.
- d Describe and evaluate **two** ways of treating substance misuse including drug treatment in heroin dependence (the Biological Approach) and **one other**.

Suitable examples:

 - aversion therapy for smoking or alcohol abuse (the Learning Approach)
 - token economy for drug use (the Learning Approach)
 - the AA Approach.
- e Describe and evaluate **one** campaign that has encouraged people not to use recreational drugs.

Note: In examination, students may be given stimulus material about the application and asked to describe and evaluate, drawing on knowledge of the application and the five psychological approaches in AS.

4 Studies in detail

Describe and evaluate **one** study on heroin: Blattler et al (2002) Decreasing intravenous cocaine use in opiate users treated with prescribed heroin and **one other** study. This **must** be selected from a study on alcohol, cocaine, ecstasy, marijuana, or smoking/nicotine.

Suitable examples:

- Alcohol: Stacy et al (1991) Cognitive motivations and sensation seeking as long-term predictors of drinking problems
- Ecstasy: Wareing et al (2000) Working memory deficits in current and previous users of MDMA
- Marijuana: Brook et al (1999) Consequences of adolescent marijuana use: incompatibility with the assumption of adult roles
- Smoking: Morgan and Grube (1991) Closeness and peer group influence
- Smoking: Ennett et al (1994) variability in cigarette smoking within and between adolescent friendship cliques.

5 Evidence in practice: short practical on a key issue

- a Describe **one** key issue in health psychology, using the content studied within the application.

Suitable examples:

- the issue of how drug abuse can be treated
- the issue of how to prevent drug abuse
- cross-cultural differences in drug taking.

And either

- b Conduct a content analysis of magazine or newspaper articles (can include TV or web-based material) concerning the key issue. Write up the findings. Draw conclusions about the findings, linked to concepts, theories and/or research (as appropriate) from the topic of relevance.

Or

- c Summarise **two** magazine or newspaper articles (can include TV or web-based material) concerning a topic covered within this application. Write up the summaries. Draw conclusions about their findings, linked to concepts, theories and/or research (as appropriate) from the topic of relevance.

Students can conduct either of these activities but **must** complete one content analysis and one article analysis with summary across their two options.

3.3d Sport psychology

Students will be assessed on their ability to:

- 1 Definition of the application**
 - a Define sport psychology, showing understanding that it is about looking at how people choose certain sports; what affects whether someone is a good sportsperson or not and other issues such as how to improve sporting performance.
 - b Define and use terms appropriately and accurately in a psychological context including:
 - i participation
 - ii excellence
 - iii intrinsic motivation
 - iv extrinsic motivation
 - v arousal
 - vi anxiety
 - vii audience effect
 - viii qualitative data
 - ix quantitative data.

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- 2 Methodology/ How Science Works**
 - a Describe and evaluate the use of questionnaires and correlations as a research method in sport psychology.
 - b Evaluate, including the relative strengths and weaknesses, the research methods listed in a above including:
 - their use in sport psychology
 - reliability, validity and ethical issues.
 - c Outline what is meant by qualitative and quantitative data and compare in terms of strengths and weaknesses.

Note: In examination, students may be asked about the methods used in the application and asked to describe and evaluate, drawing on other methods both within the application and the five psychological approaches in AS.

3 Content

- a Describe and evaluate (including relative strengths and weaknesses) **two** explanations, for individual differences in sporting participation and performance. One must be the effect of personality traits (from the Biological Approach) and **one** other from:
- i the effect of socialisation (from the Social Approach)
 - ii the effect of attribution (from the Cognitive Approach)
 - iii the effect of reinforcement(s) (from the Learning Approach).

- b Describe and evaluate the achievement motivation theory and **one other** theory.

Suitable examples:

- Bandura — self-efficacy theory
- cognitive evaluation theory.

- c Describe and evaluate the inverted U hypothesis and **one other** theory. The theories must cover the effects of arousal, anxiety and the audience.

Suitable examples:

- catastrophe theory
- optimal level of arousal theory
- drive theory
- evaluation apprehension theory.

- d Describe and evaluate **two** psychological techniques for improving performance in sport.

Suitable examples:

- attribution retraining
- goal setting
- imagery.

Note: In examination, students may be given stimulus material about the application and asked to describe and evaluate, drawing on knowledge of the application and the five psychological approaches in AS.

4 Studies in detail

- a Describe and evaluate Boyd J and Munroe K J (2003) The use of imagery in climbing and **one other** study. This **must** be selected from the following
 - Cottrell et al (1968) — Performance in the presence of other human beings: Mere presence, audience and affiliation effects
 - Koivula (1995) — Ratings of gender appropriateness of sports participation: Effects of gender-based schematic processing
 - Craft et al (2003) — The Relationship Between the Competitive State Anxiety Inventory-2 and Sport Performance: A Meta-Analysis.

5 Evidence in practice: short practical on a key issue

- a Describe **one** key issue in sport psychology, using the content studied within the application.

Suitable examples:

- the issue of gender differences in sport
- the issue of what makes a winner
- the issue of what makes a good coach.

And either

- b Conduct a content analysis of magazine or newspaper articles (can include TV or web-based material) concerning the key issue. Write up the findings. Draw conclusions about the findings, linked to concepts, theories and/or research (as appropriate) from the topic of relevance.

Or

- c Summarise **two** magazine or newspaper articles (can include TV or web-based material) concerning a topic covered within this application. Write up the summaries. Draw conclusions about their findings, linked to concepts, theories and/or research (as appropriate) from the topic of relevance.

Students can conduct either of these activities but **must** complete one content analysis and one article analysis with summary across their two options.